How I build talks with Claude & Skills

and what I still do by hand

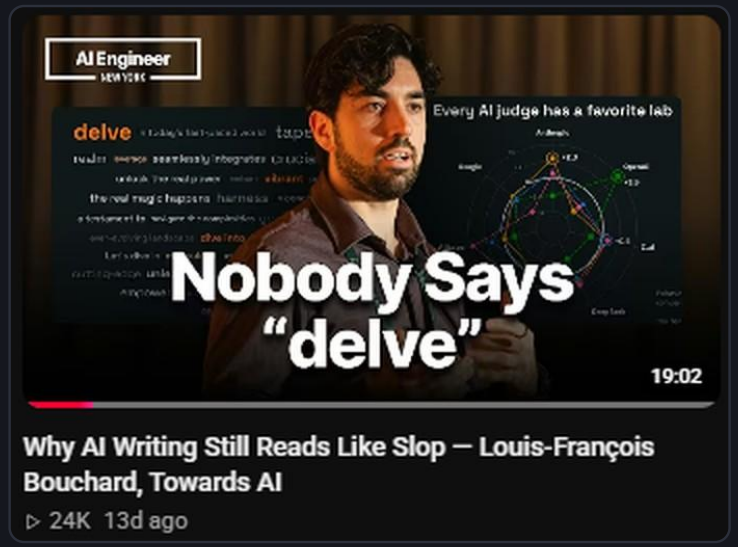
Louis-François Bouchard · CTO and co-founder, Towards AI

My skill format

`talk-decks/`	One folder, plain Markdown
`SKILL.md`	When to use it, and the rules Claude follows
`FEEDBACK.md`	Every correction I make, logged after each run
`references/`	Longer how-tos, read only when needed
`preparation-and-rehearsal.md`	

Corrections I repeat move from `FEEDBACK.md` into `SKILL.md`.

This talk started way off



AI Engineer NYC, Oct 13 · YouTube views as of Nov 4

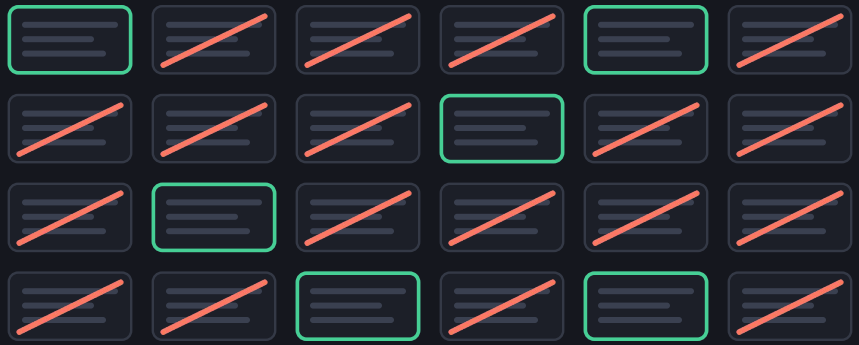
My first practice run after **generating slides**, Sept 28:

~42:00

for an **18:00** slot

The slides looked nice.
The story was slop.

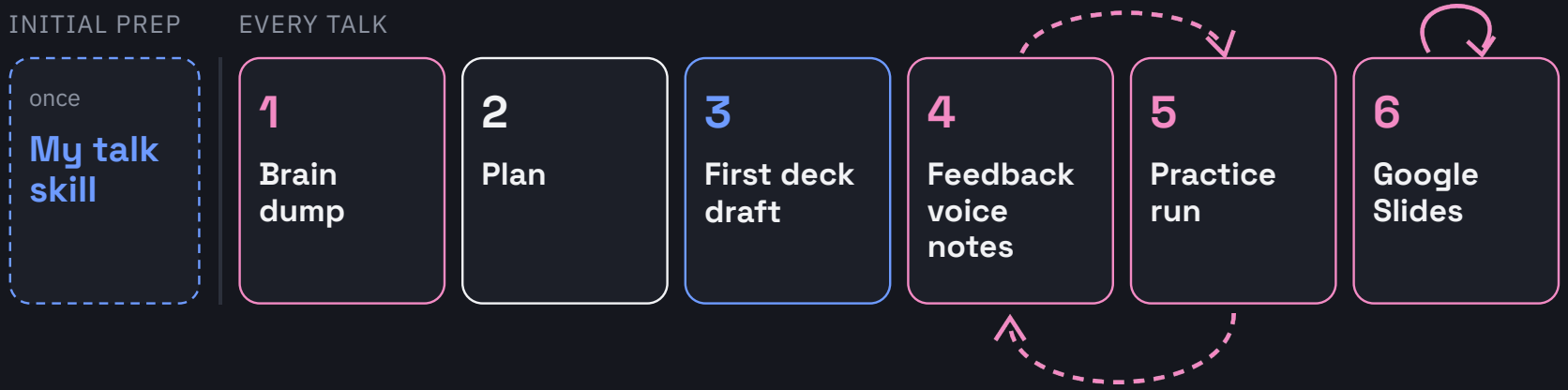
Ask Claude for a deck. Delete most of it.



- **Too much text**
- Every **slide stands alone**
- **Generic** examples
- About the topic, **not this room**

The fix isn’t less AI slop. It’s a real feedback loop.

The whole loop



Claude does most of it I do most of it both

A skill made of my corrections

12:57 *“Slide 12: Those are quite bad examples. I think we need more updated ones because we are in 2026, and they can be faked.”*

15:32 *“i dont like slide 12, I want examples of slop not people complaining...”*

15:48 *“new slide 12 is just as bad.”*

my advanced prompting skills

→

`talk-decks/SKILL.md`

Slop examples must be slop, with the slop phrases highlighted and labelled.



Get the skill

`github.com/louisfb01/oreilly-skills`

What’s in the skill

talk-decks/SKILL.md

```
## Preparing a new talk
Define what this audience should leave able
to do. Iterate on the outline before slides.

## Editing an existing deck
A request to add content is an edit in place.

## Style rules
One title per slide. No eyebrow line.
Tweets are always real x.com screenshots.
Charts have labelled axes.

## Check before sending
Check every slide in the real renderer.
```

talk-decks/FEEDBACK.md

```
### 2026-10-01 content read as structure
Corrected: “no no i didnt want to…”
Status: promoted 2026-10-27

### 2026-10-08 .pptx broke in Slides
Corrected: “you need to check…”
Status: promoted 2026-10-27

### 2026-10-30 learn from recordings
Status: logged
```

It shapes the first draft. After that, its only me directions.

Step 1: brain dump, out loud

I just talk, into Wispr Flow

- title
- rough flow
- points I must hit
- what to avoid
- research
- numbers
- screenshots
- real posts

“A talk isn’t about you, it’s about them.”

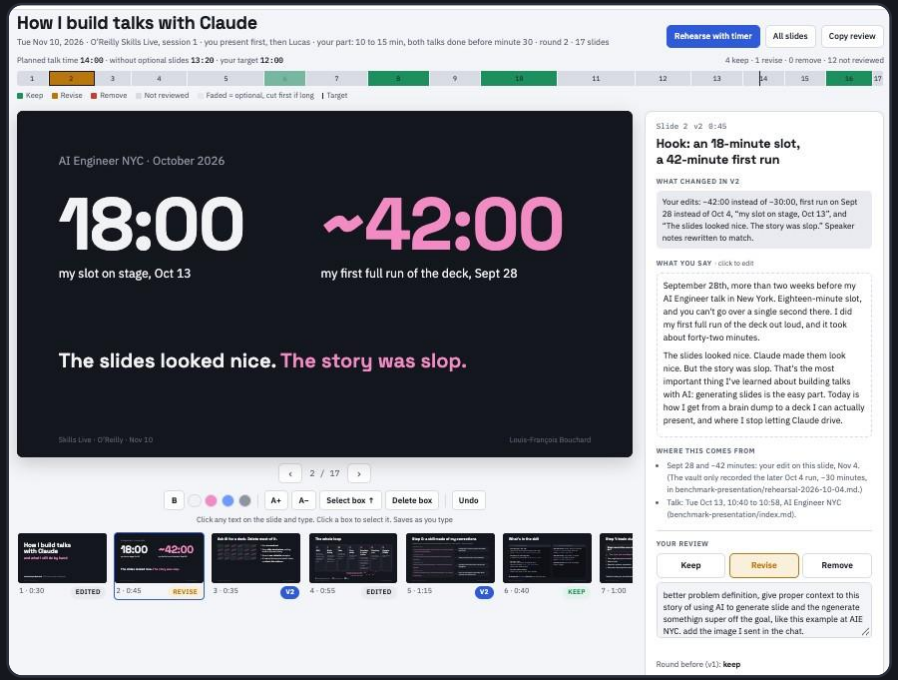
Step 2: a plan before any slide



Meme credit: @digitallybaffled

I spend time on the order while it's 6 lines, not 38 slides of pure slop.

Step 3: a first deck draft, in Artifacts



The review page Claude built for this deck

- The whole story, end to end
- Story first, style later
- I can edit any slide right there
- Keep, revise or remove each slide, with a voice note

Step 4: feedback voice notes

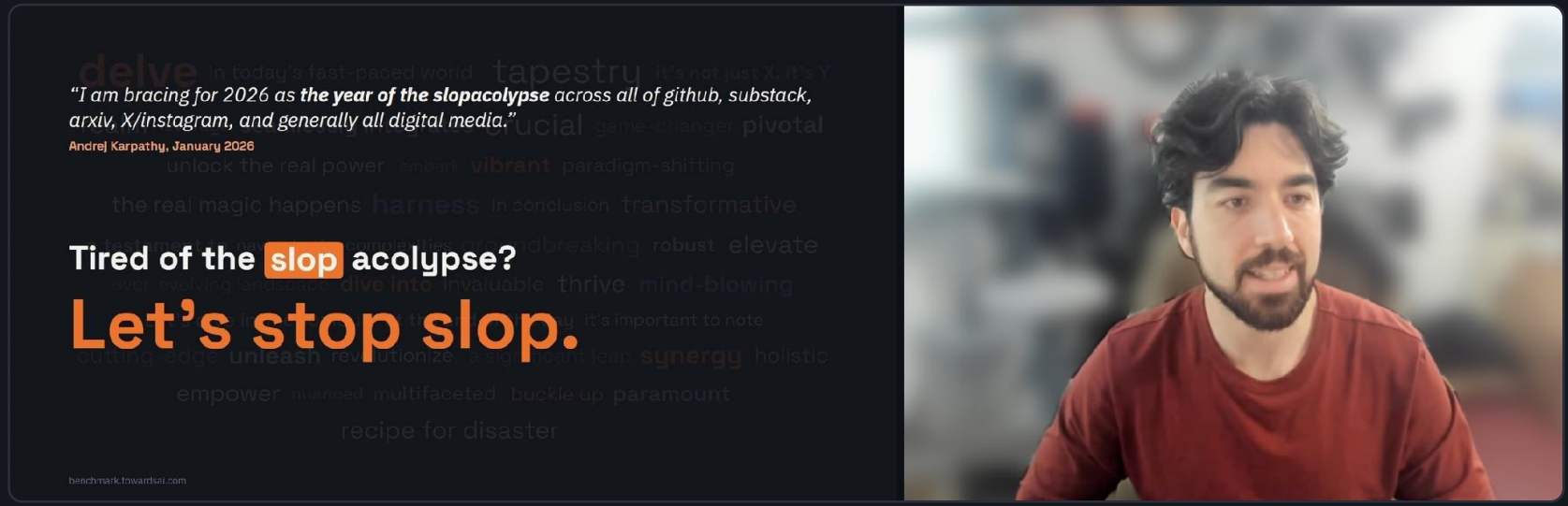
dictated while clicking through the deck

Setop having 2 titles. I just want clean simple slides...
slide 15 is quite bad...
slide 18 -- why is jev 'calibrated on avg'?...
can be just one slide instead of 4-5 you have now and I will say those things out loud, just note them in the speaker notes.

AIE deck · Oct 2 · one message · 4,695 characters · 14 slides mentioned

- By slide number, like someone is next to me
- Say why, not only what
- One long note per pass, same thread
- Voice allows to just brain dump every thought, as if talking to someone

Step 5: practice run, out loud



timed | end to end | as soon as it makes sense

AIE NYC practice, Oct 10, recorded at home

I pause to note what to fix, by number: `slide 2… slide 3…`

What the first run shows me

- ✓ The content is good, and some slides are good
- ✗ Tons of slides aren’t
- ✗ Many slides don’t fit the story
- ✗ Way too long: **42 minutes for 18**
- → How to reorganize the slides

Claude can’t fix this part. I’m the one telling the story.

The story needs to make sense to **me.**

Then: run it again, cut again

Sep 26 — Brain dump, plan, first deck

Sep 28 — First run out loud: ~42 min

Oct 2 — Three review rounds in one day

Oct 4 — Run again: ~30 min

Oct 5 — “its too long right now”: cut to 26 slides

Oct 9 — Final pass in Google Slides

Oct 10 — Recorded run: 22:55

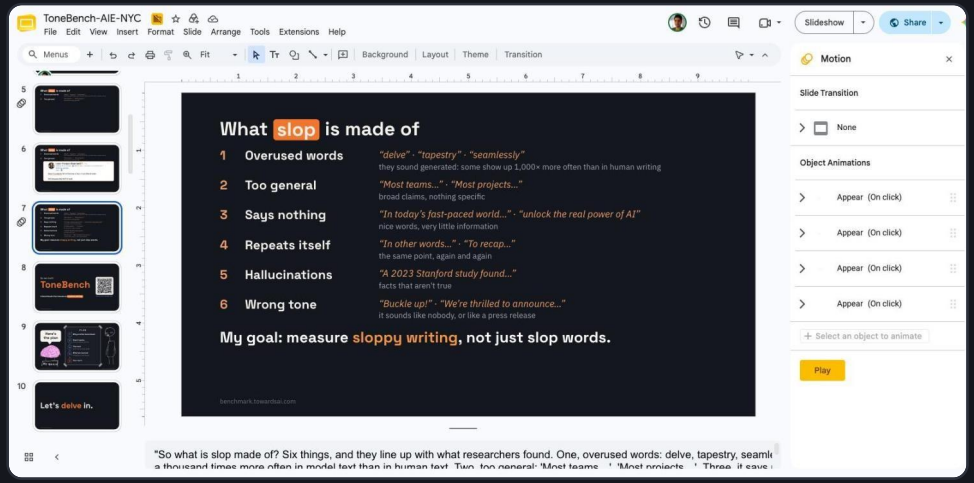
Oct 13 — On stage

42 → **~30** → **23** → **18**

minutes, Sep 28 · Oct 4 · Oct 10 · on stage, Oct 13

Record, record, record. Oct 10 to 13: I listened to my recorded runs almost **10 times**.

Step 6: Google Slides, by hand



My AI Engineer NYC deck, in Google Slides

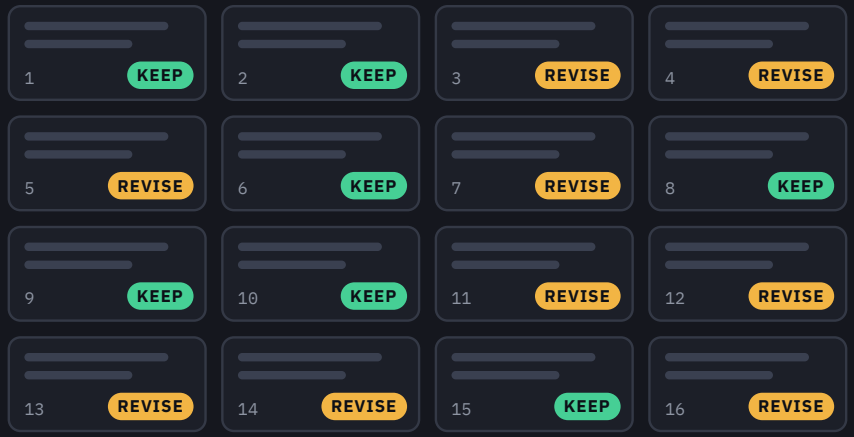
Claude converts it

real bullets, and animations: one point at a time

I fine-tune while I practice

cut text, write the transitions, find the jokes

This deck went through the same loop



Round 1: my verdict on each of these 16 slides

Brain dump: our 4 calls + my notes + my skill

Review rounds: 6

Slides changed along the way: 22

Timed runs: 4

Round 3 came from a call with Lucas, read straight from my meeting notes.

Questions?
Put them in the chat.

I’m in the chat while Lucas covers his workflow.



The skill, and a prompt to build yours

`github.com/louisfb01/oreilly-skills`